Variables in Python

BEGINNER LESSON | Qspiders | Python 3

Learning goals: Create, use, update, and name simple variables.

1. What is a variable?

A variable is a name that refers to a value. It lets you reuse that value in a program.

2. Create and use a variable

Use = to assign the value on the right to the name on the left. No separate declaration is needed.

```
name = "Asha"
age = 18
print(name)  # Output: Asha
print(age)   # Output: 18
```

Remember: Assign a value before using a variable. Text values need quotes; numbers do not. `print("name")` displays the text `name`, while `print(name)` displays `Asha`.

3. Change a variable's value

Assign a new value to the same name to update it.

```
score = 10
score = 20
print(score)  # Output: 20
```

4. Basic naming rules

- Start with a letter or underscore (_), never a digit.
- Use letters, digits, and underscores; no spaces or hyphens.
- Do not use Python keywords such as `if` or `for`.
- Names are case sensitive: `age` and `Age` are different.

Valid: `name, student_age, score2`
Invalid: `2score, first name, student-age`
Good habit: Choose clear names, such as `student_age`.

5. Try it yourself

Create `city` with your city name and print it. Then assign a different city name to `city` and print it again.

Next lesson: Data types.